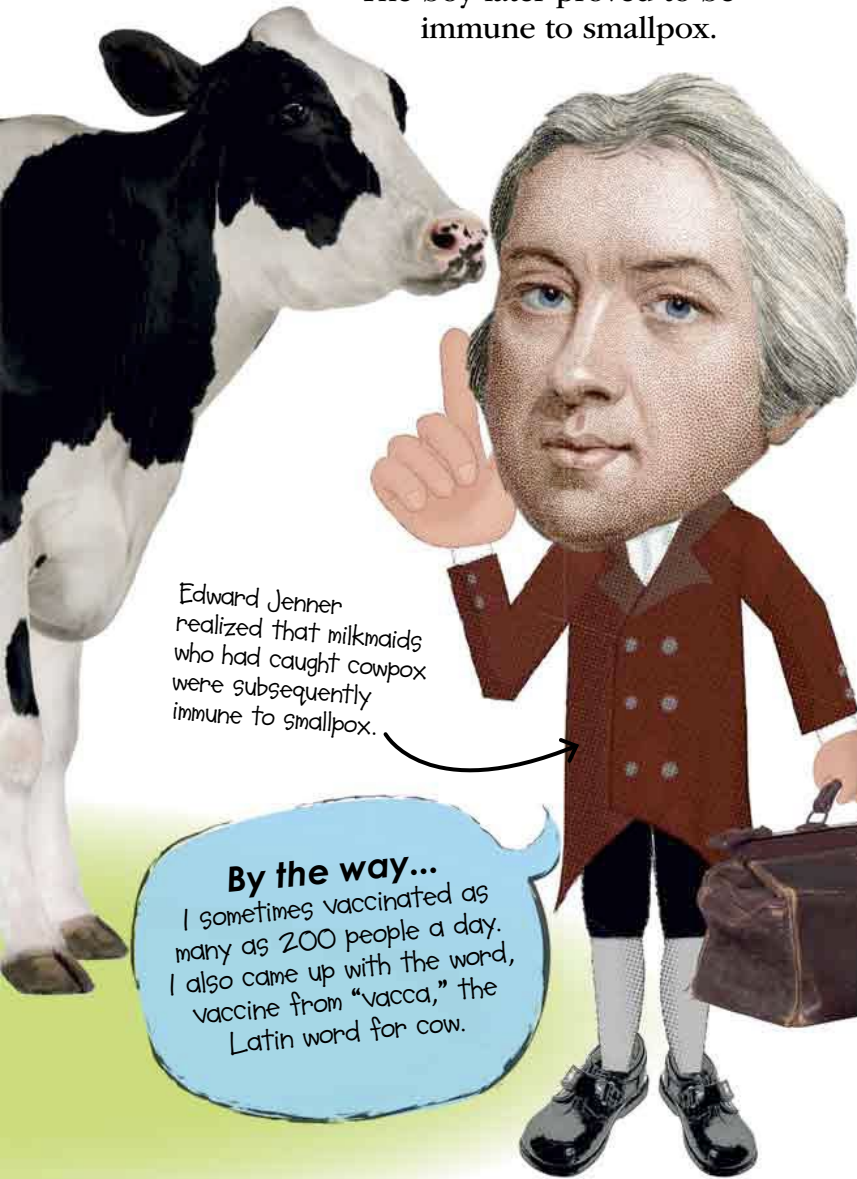


Risky research

In the 18th century, smallpox was a **MAJOR KILLER**: Around 400,000 people died of the disease every year in Europe alone. In 1796, English doctor **Edward Jenner** infected an eight-year-old boy with a small amount of cowpox pus. Cowpox was similar to smallpox but much less dangerous. **Success!**

The boy later proved to be immune to smallpox.

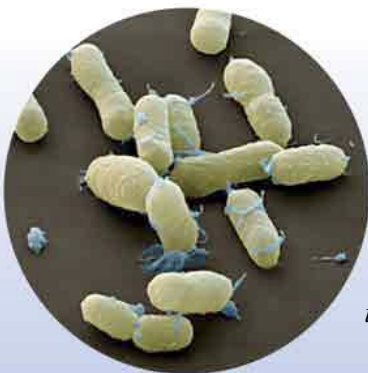


Vaccination station

A century later, French chemist **Louis Pasteur** made the next major breakthrough. In 1885, a young boy suffering from rabies arrived at his lab **close to death**. Pasteur had been experimenting with turning a weakened form of rabies into a vaccine, and gave the boy a **SERIES OF INJECTIONS**. The boy regained full health, Pasteur went on to vaccinate thousands of people, and today many vaccines are **still made using his methods**.

How it changed the world

Many were horrified at Jenner's work, but vaccination caught on. In 1979, the World Health Organization declared that smallpox had finally been wiped out. Pasteur's work led to research into other vaccines, and today we are protected against many once-common killers.



Swiss-born doctor **ALEXANDRE YERSIN** created a vaccine against **DIPHTHERIA** and in 1894 discovered the *Yersinia pestis* bacteria that caused **BUBONIC PLAGUE**.



HIV is a devastating virus that breaks down the human body's immune system. **MASSIVE RESEARCH** is ongoing to discover a vaccine against HIV.